



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Do you have the skill set for that job?



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What is your personality type? Are you outgoing? Well organized?
- Is your personality type appropriate for the job you have or want to have? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about behavior and personality in the workplace.
- I can talk about what is advisable.
- I can offer advice, solutions, or opinions about jobs and work.





Let's Explore!

Sally responds to Angela's letter of recommendation. Angela really wants this job!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear Angela,

Thank you for forwarding your reference letter from the Cambridge Community Center. I see that you are a very pro-active and talented person. I am sure you will do well in the field of journalism.

You asked me to describe my career. Let me tell you about the skill set required for journalism. First of all, you had better stay cool under pressure. There are always lots of deadlines to respect. To be a journalist, you ought to be enthusiastic, well organized and a hard-worker. You had better be able to manage your time. You should understand what your priorities are at each moment. You might want to keep a notebook or recording device with you at all times. You never know when the next great idea is going to come along!

Is it a stressful job? It can be, but if you keep your head above water, you'll be fine. I would just take one day at a time. I would try not to dwell on the difficult parts. Journalists are usually friendly people. You could ask people for help if you need it.

Good luck! Please feel free to contact me anytime!

Best,
Sally Davis





Let's Practice!

Sally gives her opinion about journalists.

Instructions: Read the letter of recommendation again. Select the correct answers.

- 1) In Sally's opinion, a good journalist ...
- a. stays calm.
 - b. respects deadlines.
 - c. is enthusiastic and well organized.
 - d. knows a lot about world events.
 - e. is friendly and charming.
 - f. works too hard.
 - g. manages their time effectively.
 - h. knows what their priorities are.
 - i. has lots of contacts.



Let's Practice!

Sally talks about what is advisable* if you want to be a journalist.

*Expressions for saying what is *advisable* (ought to, had better) are generally stronger than modals for giving suggestions.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) To / to / a / be / a / you / journalist, / be / ought / hard-worker

- 2) to / had / You / manage / better / your / able / be / time

- 3) keep / times / might / want / You / notebook / all / a / at / to / you / with



Extension Activity

Write an advice column for the newspaper about how to deal with problems at work.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose a funny name for your advice column, like *Dr. Help-Phil*.
- Think of 3 common problems people have at work.
- 3 people are writing to you to explain their problem. Write their messages. Start each message with *Dear Dr. Help-Phil ...* and then explain the problem.
- End each message with a funny name, like *Mr. Don't Know What to Do*.
- Respond to each problem. Start the response with their name, like *Dear Mr. Don't Know What to do*.
- Give suggestions and advice to solve each problem. Use the modals *should* and *could*, and expressions like *You ought to ...* or *You had better ...*
- Sign your response.
- Read your advice column to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I identify common problems at work.

☐ ☐

I give suggestions.

☐ ☐

I give advice.

☐ ☐

I read my advice column aloud.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **skill set** (noun): series of abilities; things you can do
e.g. Let me tell you about the skill set required for journalism.
- **to stay cool under pressure** (expression): remain calm in stressful situations
e.g. First of all, you had better stay cool under pressure.
- **enthusiastic** (adjective): excited; motivated to do something
e.g. To be a journalist, you ought to be enthusiastic, well organized and a hard-worker.
- **pro-active** (adjective): forward-thinking; able to anticipate problems or situations before they happen
e.g. I see that you are a very pro-active and talented person.
- **personality type** (noun): the way you usually act around people
e.g. You should have an outgoing personality type to be in journalism.





Learning Points

Talking About What is Advisable

You can use the structures *had better to*, *ought to* and *might want to* to talk about things that are advisable.

Had better has the same basic meaning as *should* and *ought to*:
This is a good idea. This is good advice.

Had better usually implies a warning about possible bad consequences:
You had better not put hot water on a burn.

In the negative form *had better*, *ought to*, and *might want to* don't have a contracted form.

Negative Sentence	Contraction
You should not put hot water on a burn.	You shouldn't put hot water on a burn.
You had better not put hot water on a burn.	(There is no contraction.)
You ought not to put hot water on a burn.	(There is no contraction.)
You might not want to put hot water on a burn.	(There is no contraction.)

Examples:

- *You had better stay cool under pressure.*
- *To be a journalist, you ought to be enthusiastic, well organized and a hard-worker.*





Learning Points

Modals for Advice and Suggestions

When you want to offer advice or give solutions to a problem, you use modals like *might*, *must*, *should* or *could*.

Look at the chart below to see how to use these modals:

Subject	Modal Verb	Base Verb	
I You He/She/It We They	might must should could	call	the office.

Examples:

- *You should be able to manage your time.*
- *You must know what your priorities are at each moment.*

